

0.0.1 The Triple Knowledge (excerpt)

tevijjasuttaṃ (excerpt)

1. Thus apparently, O Vasettha, among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one brahmin who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher of teachers who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one in the seven generations of teachers who is able to see Brahma.

iti kira vāsetṭha natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekabrāhmaṇopi yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyopi yena brahmā sakkhidiṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyapācariyopi yena brahmā sakkhidiṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ yāva sattamā ācariyamahayugā yena brahmā sakkhi diṭṭho -

2. Apparently, even the ancient triple-knowledge brahmin seers, composers of the mantras, proclaimers of the mantras, this ancient mantra verses proclaimed and composed [by them], of which at present, the triple-knowledge brahmins chant, recite, rehearse, continuously repeating what was said, causing to pass down what has been recited, that is to say: Attaka, Vamaka,

Vamadeva, Vessamitta, Yamataggi, Angirasa, Bharadvaja, Vasettha, Kassapa, Bhagu, even they do not speak thus: “We know thus, we see thus, how Brahma or when Brahma or where Brahma [appears].” Surely those triple-knowledge brahmins who speak thus: “We teach the path to union with that which we do not know, to that which we do not see, this is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to liberation, which practicing accordingly, leads to union with Brahma.”

yepi kira tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ pubbakā isayo mantānaṃ kattāro mantānaṃ pavattāro, yesamidaṃ etarahi tevijjā brāhmaṇā porāṇaṃ mantapaḍaṃ gītaṃ pavuttaṃ samūhitaṃ tadanugāyanti tadanubhāsanti bhāsitamanubhāsanti vācitanuvinācenti, seyyathidaṃ: aṭṭako vāmako vāmadevo vessāmitto yamataggi āṅgirasso bhāradvājo vāseṭṭho kassapo bhagu, tepi na evamāhaṃsu: mayametam jānāma mayametam passāma yattha vā brahmā yena vā brahmā yaṃ vā brahmāti. te vata tevijjā brāhmaṇā evamāhaṃsu: yaṃ mayam na jānāma yaṃ na passāma, tassa saḥavyatāya maggaṃ desema: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañja-sāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāti takkarassa brahmasaḥavyatāyāti.

3. “So what do you think, O Vasettha, that being so, doesn’t the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be less than stellar?”

taṃ kimmaññasi vāseṭṭha, tanu evaṃ sante tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihīrakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampajjati?ti.

4. “Certainly, O Bhante, that being so, the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be less than stellar.”

addhā kho bho gotama, evaṃ sante tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihīrakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampajjati.

5. Good Vasettha. Indeed O Vasettha, that those triple-knowledge brahmins [could] teach a path to union with that which they do not know, that which they do not see, [claiming]: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to liberation, which practicing accordingly, leads to union with Brahma,” this possibility is not to be found. Just as, O Vasettha, a line of blind men go on in succession holding on to each other, the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. So too, O Vasettha, the statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins seem to me like a line of blind men; the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. These statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be mere speech, turn out to be mere words, turn out to be simply empty, turn out to be simply hollow.

sādhū vāseṭṭha. te vata vāseṭṭha tevijjā brāhmaṇā
 yaṃ na jānanti yaṃ na passanti tassa saḥavya-
 tāya maggaṃ desessanti: ayameva ujumaggo aya-
 mañjasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāni takkarassa brah-
 masahavyatāyāti netam ṭhānaṃ vijjati. seyyathāpi
 vāseṭṭha andhavaṇiparamparaṃ saṃsattā purimopi
 na passati majjhimopi na passati pacchimopi na
 passati, evameva kho vāseṭṭha andhavaṇūpamaṃ
 maññe tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ bhāsitaṃ. puri-
 mopi na passati. majjhimopi na passati. pacchi-
 mopi na passati. tesamidaṃ tevijjānaṃ brāhma-
 ṇānaṃ bhāsitaṃ bhassakaññeva sampajjati, nā-
 makaññeva sampajjati. rittakaññeva sampajjati,
 tucchakaññeva sampajjati.

